

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is accompanied by guitar chords and fingerings. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three stanzas of text. The chords are indicated by letters (E-flat, Fm, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, B-flat/sus, B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, Fm, G, E-flat/G, Gm, Fm, B-flat, E-flat) and diagrams showing the fretboard positions. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-4 and 'x' for natural harmonics. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
twen - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.